

First Read

China Copper Foil

Feedback from recent investor conversations

Equities

China

Mining

Divergence in share performance puts HVLP execution in focus

MTD share performance has diverged meaningfully across the AI copper foil supply chain, with Defu (+15%) outperforming global peers such as Mitsui Kinzoku (-22%) and Co-tech (-8%). Following our recent [copper foil update](#), which highlighted Defu's September HVLP target production of c700t, close to Mitsui's H226 target of 730t, we discussed the sector with 10+ investors. While the market remains constructive on AI-driven demand growth, investor focus has shifted increasingly toward execution. Key areas of debate include: (1) realised HVLP shipments and yield progression; (2) the achievability of 2027 volume and capacity targets; and (3) whether battery foil profit recovery can be sustained.

HVLP: volume execution and earnings delivery remain the key debate

Investors remain constructive on AI-driven HVLP demand, but the key debate is whether the recent ramp can be sustained and translated into earnings. [Defu reported](#) 73t of HVLP4 shipments in August, with yield of around 60%, and targets total HVLP shipments of 900–1,000t/month in 1Q27 and more than 2,000t/month in 3Q27. Investors are looking for consistent monthly volumes, a higher HVLP4 mix, stable yield, repeat orders and corresponding margin contribution. We therefore see 3Q/4Q results and subsequent operating updates as the key checkpoints for volume execution and earnings delivery.

Battery Foil: major-customer price increases support a clearer profit inflection

Our industry checks suggest that major battery customers have accepted processing-fee increases of around Rmb1,000–2,000/t, effective from 4Q, following increases of around Rmb1,500–2,000/t at tier-two customers during 3Q. Looking into 2027, [ICCSINO expects](#) China copper foil utilisation rate to rise from 92% in 2026 to 98% in 2027, supporting continued processing fee upside into year-end or Q127. Investor concerns focus more on the sustainability of profitability beyond 2027: while most existing producers have limited expansion appetite after several years of losses, stretched balance sheets and still-unattractive investment returns, capacity plans by leading battery manufacturers could eventually limit further processing-fee increases.

Stock implications: Earnings risks skewing to the upside

We have Neutral ratings on Defu Technology (301511.SZ) and Nuode New Materials (600110.SH) but see earnings risks skewing to the upside. Primary upside risks include: (1) a faster-than-expected HVLP shipment ramp at Defu (HVLP1-4 products certification already completed); and (2) successful completion of HVLP4 vendor qualification at Nuode (HVLP1-3 certification already completed).

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Valuation Method and Risk Statement

We believe the risks inherent to the electric vehicle (EV) battery materials sector include, but are not limited to, the volatile nature of commodity prices and currency, which may differ materially from expectations. The sector is also exposed to government EV regulations and global policies on climate change, which could significantly impact company/industry performance.

DEFU:

Our price target is based on PE multiple.

Company-specific upside risks include: 1) faster-than-expected HVLP qualification progress and shipment ramp-up; and 2) further increases in processing fees driven by improving supply-demand dynamics.

Company-specific downside risks include: 1) slower-than-expected HVLP qualification progress and lower-than-expected shipment delivery; 2) deteriorated competitive landscape that results in price cuts; 3) technological disruption that replaces existing products; 4) weaker-than-expected recovery in battery copper foil/HTE copper foil demand.

Nuode:

Our price target is based on P/BV.

Company-specific upside risks include: 1) better-than-expected downstream demand from higher EV sales growth & ESS demand growth; 2) potential market share gain through winning key customers; and 3) technological breakthroughs by the company, including composite copper foil.

Company-specific downside risks include: 1) a deteriorating competitive landscape; 2) raw materials (mainly copper) price fluctuations; 3) faster-than-expected market adoption of new technology, including composite copper foil.

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Buy	FSR is > 6% above the MRA.	55%	24%
Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

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2:Percentage of companies within the 12-month rating category for which investment banking (IB) services were provided within the past 12 months.

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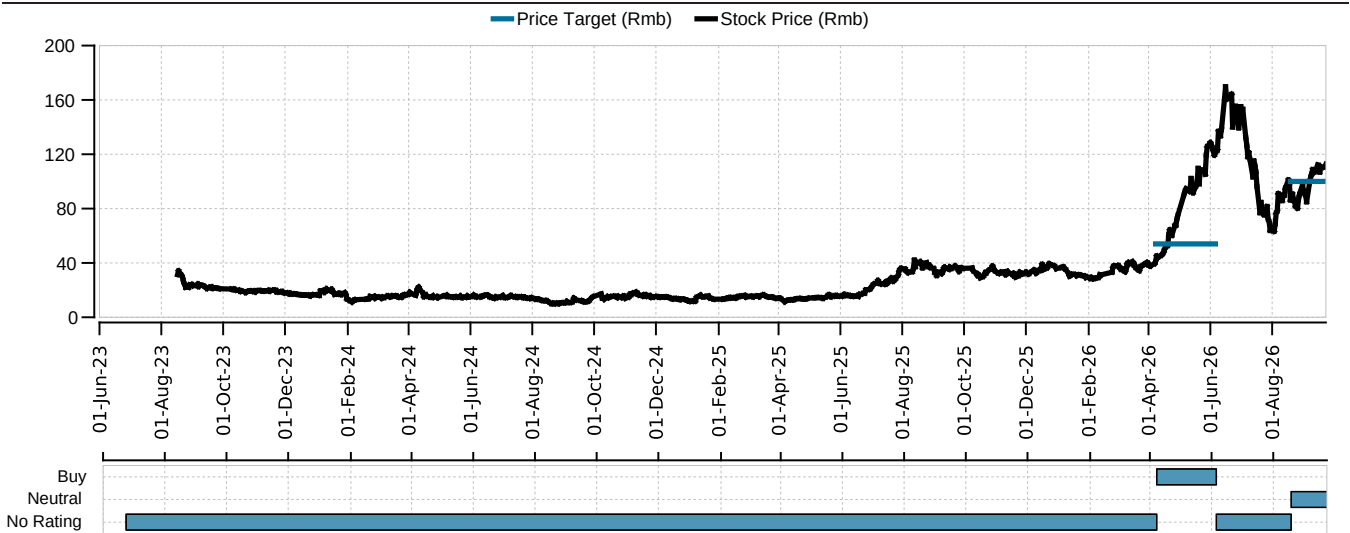
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Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
Jiujiang Defu Technology ²⁰	301511.SZ	Neutral (CBE)	Rmb112.68	23 Sep 2026
Nuode Investment	600110.SS	Neutral	Rmb12.46	23 Sep 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.
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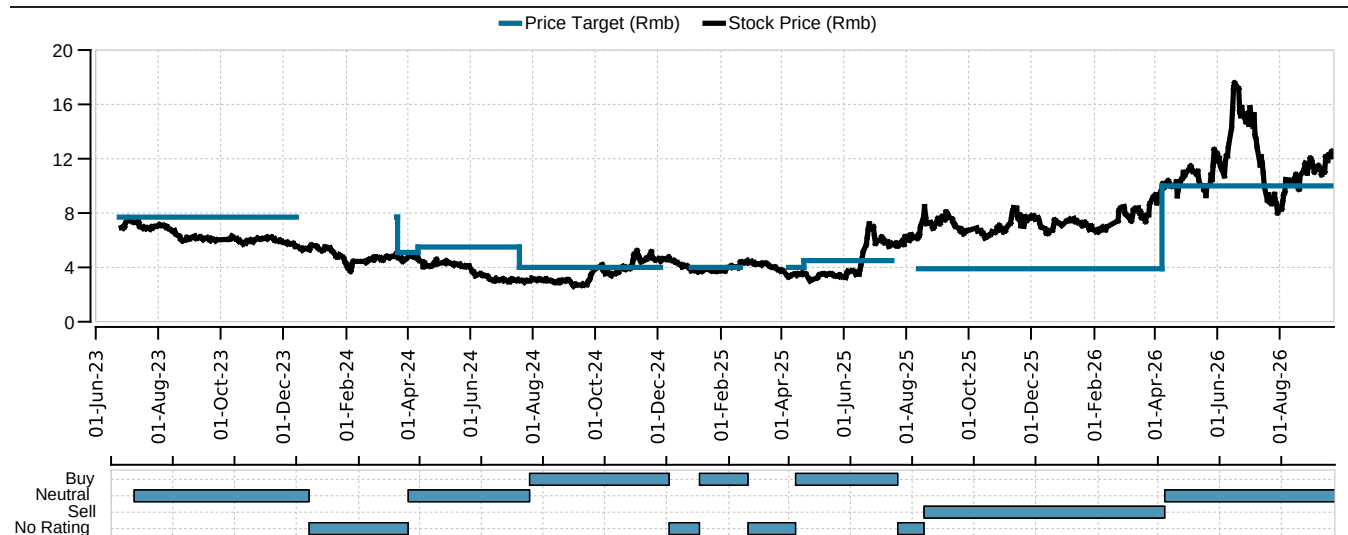
Jiujiang Defu Technology (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-06-23	NaN	-	No Rating
2026-04-07	39.50	54.00	Buy
2026-06-05	119.50	-	No Rating
2026-08-18	98.61	100.00	Neutral

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 23-Sep-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Nuode Investment (Rmb)



Date	Stock Price (Rmb)	Price Target (Rmb)	Rating
2023-06-23	NaN	7.70	Neutral
2023-12-13	5.55	-	No Rating
2024-03-20	4.95	7.70	Neutral
2024-03-21	4.90	5.10	Neutral
2024-04-10	4.87	5.50	Neutral
2024-07-18	3.09	4.00	Buy
2024-12-03	4.57	-	No Rating
2025-01-02	3.89	4.00	Buy
2025-02-19	4.03	-	No Rating
2025-04-07	3.37	4.00	Buy
2025-04-22	3.51	4.50	Buy
2025-07-17	5.66	-	No Rating
2025-08-12	6.14	3.90	Sell
2026-04-07	9.63	10.00	Neutral

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 23-Sep-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

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